

TABLE 2—BALANCE OF APPLICANTS’ BASELINE CHARACTERISTICS IN THE YEAR OF APPLICATION, AT DIFFERENT INCOME ELIGIBILITY THRESHOLDS (2008–2010 APPLICANTS)

Treatment sample (Income eligibility thresholds)	Fee waiver (L0/No grant)		€1,500 allowance (L1/L0)		€600 increment (L6/L5 to L2/L1)	
	Baseline mean	Nonparametric estimates	Baseline mean	Nonparametric estimates	Baseline mean	Nonparametric estimates
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
<i>Panel A. Each baseline characteristic separately</i>						
Female	0.599	−0.005 (0.011) 41,618 [96,390]	0.594	0.002 (0.006) 141,024 [194,513]	0.608	−0.005 (0.005) 172,909 [284,601]
Age	20.49	0.03 (0.04) 70,883 [96,390]	20.62	0.04 (0.03) 108,817 [194,513]	20.84	0.02 (0.02) 197,075 [284,601]
Baccalauréat percentile rank	61.18	−0.04 (0.47) 61,174 [89,139]	60.02	0.01 (0.24) 178,151 [178,151]	56.70	0.14 (0.30) 121,812 [254,720]
Number of preregistration choices	1.89	−0.07*** (0.02) 80,517 [96,390]	1.71	0.01 (0.01) 98,595 [194,513]	1.72	−0.00 (0.01) 178,202 [284,601]
Parents’ taxable income (euros)	48,115	66 (217) 33,379 [96,390]	34,208	48 (93) 93,392 [194,513]	22,238	86* (52) 284,601 [284,601]
Family needs assessment score	2.58	0.02 (0.06) 31,921 [96,390]	3.21	0.02 (0.04) 90,340 [194,513]	3.75	0.03 (0.03) 221,654 [284,601]
Applied for university housing	0.429	−0.016 (0.010) 63,682 [96,390]	0.319	−0.000 (0.006) 112,060 [194,513]	0.315	−0.001 (0.004) 272,276 [284,601]
Successful housing application	0.114	0.009 (0.006) 61,252 [96,390]	0.123	0.003 (0.004) 124,692 [194,513]	0.158	−0.001 (0.003) 260,070 [284,601]
<i>Panel B. All baseline characteristics jointly</i>						
χ^2 -stat		10.95		3.21		6.77
p-value		0.204		0.920		0.561

Notes: The table shows nonparametric regression discontinuity estimates to assess the difference in the value of applicants’ baseline characteristics at the income eligibility thresholds between different levels of grant. Panel A evaluates separately whether each baseline characteristic is balanced. Each coefficient comes from a separate regression, where the running variable is the applicant’s relative income-distance to the eligibility threshold. The window size for the relative income-distance to cutoff is ± 0.20 for the L0/No Grant cutoffs, ± 0.16 for the L1/L0 cutoffs and ± 0.06 for the L6/L5 to L2/L1 cutoffs. Columns 1, 3, and 5 report the mean value of the dependent variable above the income eligibility thresholds. The nonparametric estimates use the edge kernel, with bandwidth computed following Imbens and Kalyanaraman (2012). Optimal bandwidths are computed separately for each outcome and sample. Robust standard errors are shown in parentheses. The number of observations used in the nonparametric estimations are reported below the standard errors. Full sample sizes are in square brackets. Panel B tests whether the baseline characteristics are jointly balanced by (i) estimating a system of seemingly unrelated regressions where each equation represents a different baseline covariate and includes a cubic function of the running variable, which is allowed to differ on either side of the cutoffs and (ii) performing χ^2 test for the discontinuity gaps in all equations being zero. All amounts are expressed in 2011 euros.

***Significant at the 1 percent level.
**Significant at the 5 percent level.
*Significant at the 10 percent level.